

Password Policy

Northwind Technologies Pvt. Ltd. - Information Technology Policy

Document ID	Version	Effective Date	Status
IT-PWD-001	2.4	2024-11-01	Active
Owner	Approved By	Classification	Review Cycle
Head of IT Operations	CISO	Internal	Annual

1. Purpose

1.1 This policy sets minimum requirements for passwords used to access Northwind systems and applications.

2. Password Requirements

Requirement	Standard Accounts
Minimum length	12 characters
Complexity	At least 1 uppercase, 1 lowercase, 1 digit and 1 special character
Rotation	Every 90 days
Password history	Last 12 passwords cannot be reused
Lockout	Account locked for 30 minutes after 5 failed attempts

3. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

- 3.1** MFA is mandatory for email, VPN, cloud consoles and any system holding Confidential or Restricted data.
- 3.2** Approved MFA methods are the Authenticator app and hardware security keys. SMS codes are allowed only as a temporary fallback.

4. Storage and Sharing

- 4.1** Employees must use the approved password manager VaultKeeper. Passwords must never be written down, emailed or shared over chat.
- 4.2** Service accounts must use passwords of at least 20 characters generated by VaultKeeper and rotated every 180 days.

5. Forgotten Passwords

- 5.1** Reset passwords through the self-service portal at password.northwind.example. For manual resets contact the IT Service Desk on extension 4357 after identity verification.